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## Gaming

# 13 Games every self-respecting gamer should play

Gaming has a short, rich history and one packed with absolutely incredible games. Here are 13 such must-play titles that have changed the way we game

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**W**ith the deluge of blockbuster games packing incredible graphics nowadays, it'd be easy to forget the games that brought the segment to where it's at today. However, if you consider yourself a gamer, it's likely that you've played a few of the games that have achieved the mantle of 'gaming classics'. If you haven't, then make sure that you treat the following as a checklist of games that you have to play.

So, let's get into it, shall we?

## 1 Deus Ex

**Platforms:** Windows, Mac OS, PS2, PS3  
**Release year:** 2000

Developed by legendary game designer Warren Spector, Deus Ex takes place in near future America that is racked by government overreach and terrorist attacks and is policed by a reformed United Nations that employs agents augmented with mechanical organs and nanotechnology. You play JC Denton, one of two agents with nanotech augmentations, who finds himself in the middle of a secret war between shadow organizations attempting to control the world.

In terms of gameplay, Deus Ex gives you complete freedom to choose between stealth or all out gunplay peppered with

focus on skills like hacking, demolitions and lock-picking. If you intend to install Deus Ex today, make sure you do so with mods like Shifter, HDTP and New Vision installed.



## 2 The Half-Life series

**Platforms:** Windows, OS X, Linux, PS2, PS3, Xbox, Xbox 360  
**Release Year:** 1998 (Half-Life), 2004 (Half-Life 2)

Okay, so the Half-life series may actually be two games (plus two additional expansion episodes), but there's good reason for that. The Half-life games offer a masterclass in how to tell a game story without long, overproduced cinematics. The Half-Life games are also known for their solid gameplay. The first Half-Life game was known for its intelligent AI and thrilling scripted sequences, the second for Ravenholm – one of the most memorable moments in gaming.



## 3 The Elder Scrolls V: Skyrim

**Platforms:** Windows, PS3, Xbox 360  
**Release Year:** 2011

The Elder Scrolls games have a habit of completely taking over gamers' lives even months after their launch. Skyrim was no exception and as it turned out, not only was



it the best looking Elder Scrolls game to date, but it was also the most immersive. Skyrim's snowy peaks, fjords and forests populated by warring clans, giants, mammoths and dragons held on to the attention of hundreds of thousands of gamers in 2011 and still continues to do so thanks to a healthy community of modders.

## 4 Diablo II

**Platforms:** Windows, Mac OS, OS X  
**Release Year:** 2000

While the first Diablo was arguably a more influential game, Diablo II was definitely the standard – even today, ARPGs are branded a 'Diablo-clone'. Diablo II was a bigger game than its predecessor – it was longer, took place across a wider variety of environments, had a bigger pool of playable characters and a much more fleshed out online suite of gameplay modes. No wonder when Diablo III was launched in 2012, it was unfavourably compared to the 2000 game.

